FREIGHT SKILLS

SHIPPER PROSPECTING

Customer Research Guide.

Know the freight. Find the right person. Start a better conversation.



LUIS URIBE

Practical skills. Better freight businesses.

RESEARCH / UNDERSTAND / CONNECT

01 / BEFORE THE CONVERSATION

Know who you are calling.

01 / What do they ship?

Before you call a shipper you should know exactly what they ship.

This is one of the number one questions a shipper will ask you to vet you.

It shows that you have done your research.

Find this info on the company website, news articles and just general searching.

02 / Who Is the Contact?

You should make every effort to find out who the main contact is before you call.

This will increase your success rate on sales calls and help you sound more educated on the phone.

03 / How Do They Communicate?

Some shippers communicate by phone. Others prefer email. Make sure at some point in the conversation with a shipper you establish how your customer likes to communicate.

An easy way to be written off by a customer is to annoy them. This is an easy way to make sure you dont.

Watch the full Customer Research video

02 / GO ONE STEP DEEPER

Separate what you know from what you infer.

Start with evidence

Look at the company's product pages, locations, distribution information and recent announcements. Save the source and date beside the fact you want to use.

A product photograph or job title can suggest a freight need, but it does not confirm the lane, shipping frequency or purchasing authority. Mark those items as questions to verify.

Find the person responsible

Identify the most relevant logistics, transportation, supply chain or operations contact you can find. Confirm the person's role instead of assuming a title tells you who selects transportation providers.

If you reach the wrong person, ask who handles the relevant freight and how best to reach them. Record the introduction or direction you receive.

Connect the research to the conversation

Open with a truthful observation about the business. Use it to ask a specific question about their operation; do not pretend to know a problem that has not been confirmed.

Before ending the conversation, establish the preferred channel and an agreed next step. Keep the research, their answers and your follow-up together.

> **A USEFUL PRE-CALL STANDARD**
>
> You should be able to explain what the company does, why it may be relevant, who you are trying to reach, and which question you need the conversation to answer.

03 / REUSABLE WORKSHEET

Your pre-call research brief

Company / website / research date

What do they ship? Products or commodities / evidence source

What remains unconfirmed? Freight, locations, timing or service needs

Who is the contact? Name / role / source / role confirmed?

How do they communicate? Preferred channel / timing

Relevant opening question / next step after the conversation

YOUR NEXT STEP / FREE COMMUNITY

Keep learning. Keep moving.

Join the free FreightSkills community on Skool.

Put this guide to work alongside people who understand the freight business. Bring your questions, share what you are learning, and keep building your skills.

01 Guidance from Luis

Ask questions and get input from Luis in community discussions.

02 Support from other members

Compare notes, exchange ideas, and learn from the challenges other freight professionals are working through.

03 Stay current with new content

Keep up with the latest FreightSkills lessons, resources, and content announcements.

04 First dibs on giveaways

Get early notice of our giveaways and opportunities to take part.

JOIN THE FREE COMMUNITY >

Free to join. Introduce yourself and tell us what you are working on.

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